Coaching takeaways: Mark

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Key realization: Use the playbook, but make it your own. Ask questions before you pitch, use what they tell you, and close with a specific time.

Stop

- Repeating "very important business matter."
- Saying "this is an outreach call."
  It tells them it's a cold call.
- Asking "You got two minutes?"
  Once they're on the line, go straight to your question.
- Asking "Would it be worth 20 minutes?" right after the pitch.
  It gives them an easy no.
- Vague lines like "I want to evaluate and see if there's an opportunity."
- "We're not here to encourage you to make changes."
  It makes them wonder why you called.
- Negative questions like "What isn't working?"

Continue

- Your confident, conversational tone and pace.
- Active listening and thinking on your feet.
- Staying calm and persistent when they push back.
- Checking the calendar live and confirming date, time, time zone and email.
- Handing payout and money questions to the team.

Start

- Open with:
  "Thanks for taking my call. I'll be quick," then go straight to your question.
- Qualify first, then say:
  "That's exactly why I'm calling."
- For "I'm good": agree, then ask about more.
  "Do you have room to take on more clients?" Then: "What's the most time-consuming part of your week?"
- Close with two specific times.
  Are you free [day] at [time], or would [time] work better?
- After a gatekeeper transfer, always ask for their direct line.
  Tell them you'll send an invite and call 5 minutes before.
- Write your talking points after each coaching session.

Lines to keep on your screen

Gatekeeper, "Is she expecting your call?" "No, she isn't expecting my call. I'm calling on behalf of our founder, Ken Himmler. He'd like to talk with her about the practice. Is she available right now?"

Prospect, "What's in it for me?" "Fair question. Ken has built and sold a few firms, so he's been on your side of these decisions. The call is to understand where you want your practice to go, and to show you options that could fit. There's no commitment. Are you free [day] at [time], or would [time] work better?"

Prospect, "I don't want to share that." "That's fair, no problem. Can I ask a simpler one: do you have room to take on more clients right now?"

Closing "I'll send you a calendar invite right after this call, and I'll call you 5 minutes before. Is this the best number to reach you, or do you have a direct line?"

Every answer: **Answer** their question, **add** one line of context, then **ask** a question. Only say what's true, and only use approved facts.